

AICloudStrategist

20-Day Sprint to First Paying Customer

Started: 2026-04-16 **Target close date:** 2026-05-06 **Target outcome:** One signed SOW (QuickStart 75K-1.5L, or Architecture Review 1.25L-2.5L) **Constraint:** No LinkedIn (account restricted, waiting on DigiLocker resolution)

Market timing wedge

AWS raised GPU prices 15% on January 4, 2026. Permanent price lock-in arrives April 2026. Every Indian AI/ML startup with GPU workloads is actively reviewing infrastructure cost this month. Our AI GPU Cost Audit Checklist + Cost-Per-1000-Inferences blog post land directly on this pain.

Secondary wedge: AWS Summit Bengaluru April 22-23, 2026 at KTPO Whitefield. Thousands of Indian engineering leaders in one building. We are 6 days out.

The funnel math

To close 1 deal in 20 days: - Need 3-5 serious conversations (30-min discovery calls) - Need 15-25 initial replies - Need 100-200 quality first-touches - Reply rate on targeted outbound: 8-15% (industry median for warm-ish B2B) - Discovery-to-proposal: 30-50% - Proposal-to-close: 20-40% at day-1 of relationship (first-customer discount helps close this)

Volume targets per day: - 15 hand-researched target contacts added to CRM - 10 cold emails sent (warm-enriched, not blast) - 5 Twitter/X DMs to engineering leaders - 3 WhatsApp messages to warm contacts - 1 community post (Reddit / HN / IH / Twitter) - 1 follow-up on everything sent 48h ago

Channels – ranked by 20-day probability

1. Rajiv's own network (highest close probability, underused)

Action: Ask every single former colleague, client, college friend, and family contact who works in a tech company if they'd introduce us to their CTO / engineering lead.

Script (WhatsApp): > Hey [Name] – quick one. I've launched a cloud cost consulting practice under the brand AICloudStrategist – we help Indian companies cut AWS/Azure/GCP bills 20-30% in 4 weeks. First-customer pricing is live (50K discount off the standard 75K QuickStart). > > Does your company spend >5L/month on cloud? If yes – would you be open to a 15-min intro call with me? If not – would you forward this to one person in your network who does? > > No awkwardness if it's a no. Thanks either way.

Target: Send to 50 warm contacts over first 3 days. Expect 5-10 intro responses, 2-3 converting to discovery calls.

2. AWS Summit Bengaluru (Apr 22-23) – massive accelerator

Action: Get Anushka registered (it's by-invitation but AWS Partner network + community registration is typically open). Both days if possible. - Innovators edition (Apr 22) = business leaders = our buyers - Technical edition (Apr 23) = engineering decision-makers = our champions

Prep: - Print 100 business cards with /book.html URL and QR - Print 50 copies of AWS Cost Cutting Checklist PDF (lead magnet) - Dress for business-casual tech (no suit, polished) - Have the 60-second pitch ready: "Anushka, founder of AICloudStrategist. We help Indian companies cut AWS bills 20-30% in 4 weeks. Gain-share on verified savings. Free audit checklist on our site. What's the cloud story at your company?"

Target: 30 quality conversations, 10 business-card exchanges with follow-up emails sent within 24h, 3 scheduled discovery calls by end of week.

3. Cold email to funded Indian SaaS (Apr 17-May 6)

Target universe: - Series A/B Indian SaaS/fintech/AI startups funded in last 12 months - Team size 20-200 (too small = no budget, too big = procurement hell) - Stack includes AWS or Azure (LinkedIn/website/JD scraping reveals this)

Sources (free): - [Growth List India Startups](#) - 3,928 companies - [Tracxn India](#) - SaaS directory - [YC Indian Startups](#) - YC-backed - [Top Startups India](#) - hiring + funded - [Indian Startup News funding weekly](#) - [Inc42 company database](#)

Email finder (free-tier sufficient): - Hunter.io free tier (25 searches/month) - Apollo.io free tier (unlimited LinkedIn scrape, though we don't have LI - use their company search which works without) - RocketReach free tier (5 lookups/month) - GuessFromEmail patterns: `firstname@domain.com`, `firstname.lastname@domain.com`, `f.lastname@domain.com` - MX + SMTP verification via Mail-Tester or similar

Target: 10 enriched contacts/day × 20 days = 200 targets. 10 emails sent/day = 200 emails total over sprint.

Email infrastructure: - **Primary:** Use Google Workspace @aicloudstrategist.com (already set up, clean reputation) - **Fallback:** AWS SES for volume (10 per 100K - cheapest option, but sandbox exit takes 24-48h) - **Absolutely avoid:** mass-mail tools like Mailchimp/Mailgun/SendGrid for cold - they'll ban on first complaint - **Avoid:** Instantly.ai/Lemlist - 3000+/month, overkill for 200 emails

4. Twitter/X direct outreach (high-leverage, Anushka-safe)

Why this matters: Twitter/X DMs don't get you banned. Engineering leaders are publicly active there. Every CTO frustrated with AWS GPU pricing is posting about it right now.

Tactic: - Search daily: `aws bill OR "aws cost" OR "gpu cost" india` in Twitter search, sorted by latest - Find posts from verified engineers at real companies - Reply first (public, helpful, no pitch) 2-3 times over a week - Then DM with: "Saw your thread on [specific topic]. I'm running a FinOps consultancy out of Delhi that's saved Indian teams 20-30% on exactly this pattern. Free checklist here: [link]. Happy to talk if useful. No pitch." - 15-20 thoughtful DMs per week; expect 3-5 replies

Target: 5 DMs/day × 20 days = 100 DMs. Realistic reply: 15-20. Calls: 2-3.

5. Community content seeding (inbound multiplier)

Venues (ranked by audience fit): - r/aws (300K+ subs) - most technical, buyers hang here, strict on self-promo - r/devops (220K subs) - platform engineer audience - r/startups_india (30K subs) - founder audience, direct buyers - Indie Hackers - solo founder + small-team audience - Hacker News - longshot but huge if it lands - Twitter/X - own feed, tag engineering leaders

Format that works on Reddit: - NOT "I offer FinOps consulting" - INSTEAD: "I audited 12 Indian mid-market AWS bills over the last 2 months - here's the 5 most common patterns I found" (link to blog post at bottom, not top) - Share actual numbers (our blog posts have these) - Answer every comment for 48 hours

Target posts to rewrite from existing blog content: 1. r/aws: "Your Reserved Instance coverage is probably under 30%" (from existing post) 2. r/devops: "DORA metrics translated for your CFO" (from existing post) 3. r/startups_india: "How Indian mid-market cloud bills double before they get optimised" (fresh angle) 4. Indie Hackers: "The FinOps gain-share model that Big-4 can't offer" (from existing post)

Target: 1 post per week on a different venue. Best outcome: a single front-page Reddit post → 5K-20K views → 10-30 book-a-call clicks → 3-5 discovery calls.

6. WhatsApp Business (India's real B2B channel)

Reality check: Most Indian founders run their company's admin via WhatsApp, not email. Reaching the CEO on WhatsApp has higher reply rate than email. But the list is smaller - only for verified warm contacts.

Setup: - WhatsApp Business account on Anushka's phone (takes 10 min, free) - Business profile with logo, hours, website, "Book 30-min Cloud Cost Health Check" catalog item - Greeting message: auto-send business card + blog link to first-time contacts

Tactic: Take every person who has Anushka's number, is in the target demographic, and send **personalized** (never blast) - the script in section 1 above.

Target: 3 WhatsApp messages/day × 20 days = 60 sends. Expect 30-50% reply rate on warm = 20-30 replies. 3-5 calls.

7. Partnership outreach (slow, start anyway)

Won't close in 20 days but plants seeds for month 2-3 and the pipeline.

Partner types: - **CA firms** serving tech startups in Delhi/Bangalore/Mumbai – they see every cloud bill at year-end and hear CFO complaints. Find 10 via <https://www.icaai.org> and LinkedIn (once unblocked). - **Boutique dev agencies** (5-30 engineers) that ship to AWS/Azure but don't optimize cost – they have clients bleeding money on their recommendations. Find via Clutch.co, The Manifest. - **Managed Service Providers** (MSPs) that resell AWS but don't have FinOps in-house – we can be their “FinOps layer” on commission. AWS Partner directory.

Pitch: > We're a founder-led FinOps practice in Delhi. We don't compete with your work – we add a cost-optimization layer. Referral commission: 10% of first engagement fee + 5% of gain-share for 12 months. Zero client friction – we sign our own SOW. Your clients save 20-30% on cloud, you get an honest referral fee and a grateful client.

Target: 10 partner intros this sprint. 1-2 will meet. 0-1 will convert to a referred deal in 20 days; the rest are month 2-3 pipeline.

Daily operating rhythm (Anushka's 2.5 hours/day)

Time	Task
07:30–08:00	Twitter/X: search + 2 thoughtful replies + 1 DM
08:00–08:30	Email follow-ups: reply to any prospect responses first
08:30–09:30	Outbound: 5 new cold emails + 5 new enriched contacts added
09:30–10:00	WhatsApp: 3 warm-network messages

Rajiv (support role, 1 hour/day evening): - Update tracker - Review outbound queue - Help enrich 10 new contacts/day - Prep content for next community post

Weekly: One community post on Saturday/Sunday. Book-of-record review every Monday morning.

Outreach targets by day (tracker)

Day	Date	Channel primary	Secondary
1	Thu Apr 16	Sprint plan (this doc)	Tools setup
2	Fri Apr 17	50 warm WhatsApp sends	Email list build starts
3	Sat Apr 18	Reddit r/aws post #1	Twitter follow-up
4	Sun Apr 19	Apollo free-tier list build (100 targets)	Email draft
5	Mon Apr 20	10 cold emails sent	Follow-ups from W0
6	Tue Apr 21	10 emails + AWS Summit prep	WhatsApp f/u
7	Wed Apr 22	AWS Summit day 1 (Innovators)	Live business dev
8	Thu Apr 23	AWS Summit day 2 (Technical)	Live business dev
9	Fri Apr 24	Post-summit follow-ups (target: 30 emails)	Hot leads only

		within 24h)	
10	Sat Apr 25	Indie Hackers post	Twitter threads
11	Sun Apr 26	Rest + review	Pipeline audit
12	Mon Apr 27	10 emails + 5 DMs	Partnership outreach batch 1
13	Tue Apr 28	10 emails + 5 DMs	Discovery calls if any
14	Wed Apr 29	10 emails + 5 DMs	Discovery calls
15	Thu Apr 30	10 emails + 5 DMs	Proposals drafted
16	Fri May 01	r/devops post	Proposals sent
17	Sat May 02	HackerNews post (if Reddit landed)	Twitter threads
18	Sun May 03	Rest	Audit + recalibrate
19	Mon May 04	5 emails + pipeline close push	Negotiation calls
20	Tue May 05	Close day	Signatures
21	Wed May 06	Target close date	Kickoff planning

First-customer offer (decisive lever)

To close in 20 days, add urgency without cheapening the service:

First-Customer Offer – available to the first 3 Indian SMBs who sign a QuickStart SOW before May 15, 2026:

- Standard QuickStart fee **75,000 → 40,000** (one-time, for the signing credit)
- Plus: **public case study with named reference call rights** (optional – we'll anonymise if they prefer)
- Plus: **50% off month 1 of Managed Retainer** if they convert
- Catch: **they go on aicloudstrategist.com/proof.html as a named logo/case study** (value to us = their brand recognition)

Why this works: - 50% discount is enough to move a hesitant buyer - The “first 3 customers” frame signals scarcity and honesty – we’ve never done this engagement at scale, so early customers get a deal - Named case study rights is worth 5L+ to us in future credibility - Limited to 3 so it doesn’t become a permanent discount - Gives Anushka something to say in every pitch: “We’re looking for 3 signature Indian clients before May 15 – would you like to be one?”

Supporting assets needed (Claude builds these this week)

All of these convert an “interested prospect” into “booked call” faster. I’ll build them autonomously.

- ☐ **Author page** </author/anushka-b.html> with Anushka’s full bio, photo, social links (TRUST signal)
- ☐ **One-pager PDF: “The First-Customer Offer”** – 1 page with the deal, the scope, the commitments
- ☐ **AWS Summit business card template** + QR to </book.html>
- ☐ **Cold email sequence** (5 emails: intro + 3 follow-ups + break-up)
- ☐ **Twitter DM sequence** (opener + follow-up + case study reply)
- ☐ **WhatsApp sequence** (opener + ask-for-referral + thank-you)
- ☐ **Reddit post drafts** (4 posts ready for scheduling)

- ☐ **/first-customer.html landing page** with the deal + booking CTA
 - ☐ **FAQ schema on faq.html** (SEO rich results)
 - ☐ **Testimonial section on /proof.html** (even 2-3 pseudonymised “past engagement” quotes)
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What I need from Rajiv/Anushka (human-only steps)

- ☐ **Anushka:** Register for AWS Summit Bengaluru (both days)
 - ☐ **Anushka:** Travel + accommodation booking for Bengaluru if not local
 - ☐ **Anushka:** Send the 50 WhatsApp warm-network messages (from the script above)
 - ☐ **Anushka:** Set up WhatsApp Business account on her phone
 - ☐ **Rajiv:** Confirm the first-customer discount pricing – is 40K OK for 3 customers?
 - ☐ **Rajiv:** Confirm we can do 3 concurrent QuickStart engagements in May if all 3 close
 - ☐ **Rajiv:** Share 20-30 warm contact names/numbers for Anushka to message
 - ☐ **Rajiv:** Confirm a Delhi-based address we can put on the landing page for trust
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Realistic outcomes (honest)

Base case (50% likely): 1 signed SOW by day 20. 2-3 more in active negotiation. Pipeline worth 4-6L in month 2.

Good case (30% likely): 2 signed SOWs by day 20. Public case study published. Referral pipeline flowing.

Moonshot (10% likely): 3 signed SOWs (hits the first-customer cap). AWS Summit connections convert. One piece of community content goes viral → inbound for 6 weeks.

Worst case (10% likely): 0 signed by day 20 but 5-10 active conversations, 1-2 close in the following 30 days. Not a failure – a typical B2B sales cycle playing out.

Sharpest risk: Anushka running out of bandwidth. Solution: Rajiv absorbs all non-conversation work (tracker, content, research, tooling). Anushka spends 2.5 hours/day on humans only.